

## Online Complaint Summary

3/5/26 4:45 PM

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|                   |                                                     |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Board:            | <b>California Board of Registered Nursing - BRN</b> |
| License Type:     | <b>Registered Nurse - RN</b>                        |
| Complaint Number: | <b>4002026006579</b>                                |
| Incident Date:    | <b>02/03/2026</b>                                   |

Description:

**Subject: Formal Complaint – Unprofessional Conduct, Billing Fraud, and Misrepresentation of Credentials**

I am filing a formal complaint against Nurse Practitioner Kifle Jikamo regarding a telehealth encounter on February 3, 2026, facilitated by the Grow Therapy platform. My complaint is based on two specific violations of the California Business and Professions Code (BPC).

**1. Misuse of the "Dr." Title (BPC § 2054 & § 2864):**

The provider is advertised on the Grow Therapy platform as "Dr. Kifle Jikamo." During our clinical encounter, he did not clarify that he is a Nurse Practitioner. In California, the use of the title "Dr." by a non-physician in a clinical setting is a violation of the "Truth in Medical Advertising" laws if it misleads the patient. As a patient seeking specialized medication-assisted treatment (MAT), this misrepresentation is dangerous and deceptive.

**2. Unprofessional Conduct & Billing Fraud (BPC § 2761):**

On February 3, 2026, Jikamo conducted a telehealth session with me that lasted less than five minutes. He immediately refused to provide the medical care I requested (Buprenorphine treatment), citing a platform policy. He provided no clinical assessment, no diagnosis and no treatment plan.

Despite refusing care and terminating the session immediately, Jikamo submitted a claim to L.A. Care Health Plan (Claim # [REDACTED]), which has been paid via Medi-Cal funds. Billed for services not rendered is a clear act of unprofessional conduct and fraud.

**Evidence of Standard of Care:**

Another provider on the same platform, [REDACTED], handled the exact same inquiry on February 2, 2026, by ethically canceling the appointment and NOT billing my insurance. This proves that Jikamo's decision to bill for a 5-minute refusal of care was a deliberate and unethical choice.

I request that the Board investigate Kifle Jikamo's credentials, his use of the "Dr." title, and his fraudulent billing practices

involving Medi-Cal recipients.

**Incident Address 1**

|                                                                                                                |               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Business Name/Facility Name:                                                                                   | Grow Therapy  |
| Address Line 1:                                                                                                | 548 Market St |
| Address Line 2:                                                                                                | PMB 70394     |
| City:                                                                                                          | San Francisco |
| State:                                                                                                         | California    |
| Zip:                                                                                                           | 94104         |
| Hospital:                                                                                                      | No            |
| Home:                                                                                                          | No            |
| Other:                                                                                                         | Yes           |
| If you responded 'Yes' to the previous question, please provide a description of the location of the incident. | Telehealth    |

**Additional Complaint Information 1**

|                                                                                                                     |                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Have you filed a complaint with any other government agency regarding this incident?                                | Yes                                 |
| Agency Name:                                                                                                        | DHCS                                |
| Person Helping You:                                                                                                 | Pending                             |
| Phone Number:                                                                                                       | Pending                             |
| Case Number:                                                                                                        | Pending                             |
| Does this complaint concern a child custody issue?                                                                  | No                                  |
| Was the person named in this complaint appointed by the court to prepare a custody recommendation to the court?     | No                                  |
| If children are involved in this case, do you have joint legal custody of the child/children involved in this case? | No                                  |
| Have you tried to resolve or mediate this complaint?                                                                | Yes                                 |
| If yes, what was the response?                                                                                      | Emailed Grow Therapy 3/5/26 Pending |
| Reason for treatment:                                                                                               | MAT/Suboxone treatment for OUD      |
| Patient Name:                                                                                                       | Nicolas Hernandez                   |
| Date of Birth:                                                                                                      | ██████████ (mm/dd/yyyy)             |
| Relationship to the patient:                                                                                        | Self                                |
| Substandard Care (e.g. misdiagnosis, negligent treatment, delay in treatment, etc.)                                 | No                                  |

|                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Prescribing Issues (e.g. excessive/under prescribing, Internet)                                                                                                                             | <b>Yes</b>                                      |
| Unlicensed Provider or Aiding/Abetting unlicensed practice                                                                                                                                  | <b>Yes</b>                                      |
| Sexual Misconduct                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>No</b>                                       |
| Provider (e.g. Physician, Psychologist, Psychotherapist etc.) Impairment (e.g.drug, alcohol, mental physical)                                                                               | <b>No</b>                                       |
| Unprofessional Conduct (e.g. breach of confidence, record alteration, fraud, misleading advertising, arrest or conviction)                                                                  | <b>Yes</b>                                      |
| Office Practice (e.g. failure to provide patient/medical records to patient, failure to sign death certificate, patient abandonment):                                                       | <b>No</b>                                       |
| Other:                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Yes</b>                                      |
| If you selected 'Other', please explain:                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Misrepresentation of medical credentials</b> |
| If the complaint is medical/psychological/psychotherapy treatment related, please indicate the patient has been examined/treated by another provider/professional for this same condition?: | <b>Yes</b>                                      |
| If you responded 'Yes' to the previous question, please include provider name, address, and treatment dates.                                                                                |                                                 |
| Have you initiated or filed legal action regarding this incident?                                                                                                                           | <b>No</b>                                       |

**Respondent**

|                 |                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------|
| License Type:   | <b>Registered Nurse - RN</b> |
| License Number: | <b>95142520</b>              |
| First Name:     | <b>Kifle</b>                 |
| Second Name:    | <b>Gashie</b>                |
| Last Name:      | <b>Jikamo</b>                |
| Address:        |                              |

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**Complainant**

|             |                  |
|-------------|------------------|
| First Name: | <b>Nicolas</b>   |
| Last Name:  | <b>Hernandez</b> |
| Gender:     | <b>Male</b>      |
| Address:    |                  |

**LOS ANGELES**

██████████, CA

9██████████

US

Phone Number:

██████████

E-mail Address:

████████████████████

### Attachments

jikamo\_billing\_fraud.png

**Shows Claim # ██████████ as "Paid" by L.A. Care for the 2/3/26 appointment**

jikamo\_profile.png

**Shows the provider advertised as "Dr. Kifle Jikamo"**

██████████\_message.png

**Shows a different provider (██████████  
██████████) correctly canceling a similar request without billing, proving Jikamos billing was a deliberate, unethical choice**

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